

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS



FOREIGN POLICY - 1

MODULE - 1



FOREIGN POLICY - 1

MODULE - 1

MODULE - 1

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

- 1 It is a specialized area of Political Science which is driven and shaped by factors such as culture, religion, ideology, resources, finance and unrestrained power.
- 2 However, the key determinant of this study according to Darwin is survival of the fittest and domination of the strongest.

FOREIGN POLICY

- Foreign policy is an attempt to further country's national interest in the global arena, in the conduct of its relations with other countries; both bilaterally and multilaterally.
- It is reflection of a country's traditional values and her aspirations.



IDEOLOGICAL CONSIDERATIONS

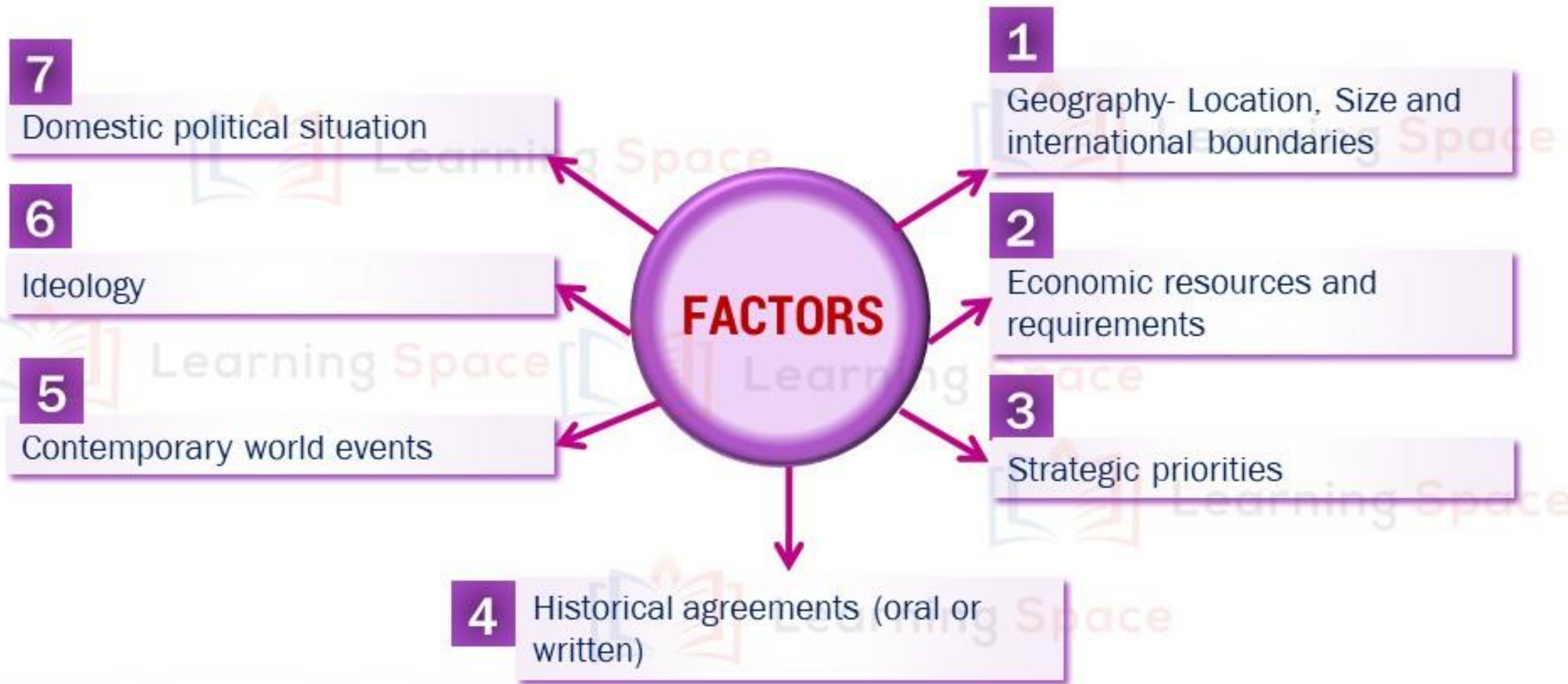
India had some ideological considerations for framing her foreign policy

- 1** Gandhian and Buddha school of thought placed equal attention to means as well as ends. Value friendship, cooperation, non-violence, universal brotherhood.
- 2** Chanakya school of thought placed more attention to ends rather than means. National interest needs to be achieved as the basic objective.

Directive principles based on Gandhian/Buddha style of thinking- non interference in internal affairs of other countries.



FACTORS INFLUENCING FOREIGN POLICY



OBJECTIVES OF FOREIGN POLICY

- Safeguard and promote National interest
- Remain sovereign and pursue independent foreign policy(Non-Alignment)
- Peace and tranquility in the region.
- Support struggles for decolonization
- Non-interference in internal matters of other states
- Foster friendship and co-operation with the countries of the world
- Foreign policy to facilitate economic development

- Serve to provide security and protect national integrity
- Enhance trade and investment.



PRE-INDEPENDENCE DAYS

- 1 The evolution of India's foreign policy can be traced back to the colonial days.
- 2 In spite of being a colonized nation, the leaders of the freedom movement laid the foundations of free India's foreign policy. This is evident from the following:
- 3
 - **1885-** Indian National Congress denounced Annexation of Upper Burma using Indian men and resources. In principle, British India was against principles of colonialism.
 - **1892-** INC showed to the world that they had disassociated themselves from British policies. A resolution was passed rejecting India being used as a base against Tibet, Burma, Afghanistan and Persia.



PRE-INDEPENDENCE DAYS

- 1
 - 1920- INC sent its sympathy to Ireland struggling for freedom.
 - WWI- During the war, India spoke against British imperialist policies.
 - 1921, the All-India Congress Committee passed a resolution stating “the present government in India did not represent Indian opinion” .

2 This statement helped displayed two things:

1. Interests of Nationalist India were different from Britain
2. The foundation of India's independent foreign policy were laid.



PRE-INDEPENDENCE DAYS

- 1** India had supported backward countries and championed the cause of the Third World countries supporting their like Baku in 1920.
- 2** In **1924**, the Belgaum Congress Session conveyed a message of sympathy to Egypt against the British colonial policy and withdrawal of Indian troops from Mesopotamia as well as from other British colonies
- 3** The Congress leaders even under the British rule were seeking moral and sympathetic support for its ongoing struggle for independence.
- 4** To protest against the use of Indian troops in China, Mesopotamia, AICC passed a resolution in March 1927 stressing the need for an independent foreign policy
- 5** In **1925**- AICC opened a Foreign department headed by JL Nehru. But because of domestic protests and lack of Nehru's clout, the department did not do well.



PRE-INDEPENDENCE DAYS

- 1** **1930**- Congress condemned the acts of Nazis and Fascists while disapproving the British foreign policy depriving countries of independence.
- 2** **1936**- Foreign dept. was established under Ram Manohar Lohia in the INC office.
- 3** Congress started press releases on important international issues and Nehru began touring various countries and organizations to articulate Congress and India's stance. These instances helped INC and India get an idea as to what India's principles of foreign policy are going to be.



PRE-INDEPENDENCE DAYS

4 **1945-** The Congress Working Committee came with a resolution criticizing UN Charter because dominant powers were made above law as far as Charter was concerned. Moreover, UN was not clear about the principles of Non-self governing territories like India.

5 **September 7, 1946-** JL Nehru declared, "India shall take full part in international conferences as a free nation with our own policy and not merely as a satellite of another nation".



PRE-INDEPENDENCE DAYS

- 1 India's international status also had gained prominence because of its positions in the global arena.
- 2 India had signed the Covenant of League of Nations and United Nations as a primary member even before independence. So foreign policy was in making.
- 3 India asked to be allowed to participate in colonial conferences which comprised colonies of British- Australia, Canada and South Africa enjoying Dominion Status(Internal autonomy).
- 4 **1917-** India was allowed to participate in these Colonial Conferences, later called Imperial Conference and finally called Commonwealth of Nations. First Int org with India's international status.



ROLE OF J L NEHRU

Jawaharlal Nehru had a very important role in formulating India's foreign policy.

1946- Nehru laid down the vision for the foreign policy of an Independent India.

- Oppose colonialism and racism in all its forms
- Stay non-aligned and continue to be sovereign and independent
- Asian solidarity to avoid neighborhood becoming a proxy-theatre of Cold war
- Nehru had followed the H. J. Laski's ideology, which was a synthesis of Liberalism and Marxism. Non-alignment was Nehru's intellectual struggle against the bipolar world



POST-INDEPENDENT INDIA

- 1** The post independent foreign policy was formulated on the considerations of the various factors like colonial experience.
- 2** Congress party resolutions, ideology of national leaders, power politics of the Super Powers, Cold War,
- 3** In order to achieve its national interests/objectives and to promote international peace, India had maintained good and friendly relations with almost all countries of the world.



PHASES OF INDIA'S FOREIGN POLICY

Indian foreign policy has evolved with time, keeping up with the changing power equations and developments in the international domain; alongside, upholding its foreign policy priorities.

The Indian foreign policy can be divided into several phases.

1

1945 - 1962

4

1991 - 2012/14

2

1962 - 1971

5

CONTEMPORARY
DEVELOPMENTS

3

1971 - 1991

1

1945 - 1962

1

This period focused on the country's development, rising from the shambles of the colonial era. It was trying to rebuild its economy and consolidate its integrity.

2

It trying to balance the Cold War politics through an optimistic Non-Alignment.

3

It also had a goal, as the first of the decolonized nations was to lead Asia and Africa in a more equitable world order. The conferences at Bandung and Belgrade and championing the cause of Third world solidarity.

4

Successful diplomacy at Korea, Vietnam, Suez canal and Hungary

5

International standing damaged with the defeat in 1962 war.



2

1962-1971

1 India had to make pragmatic choices and the phase of realism and recovery began.

2 Focus shifted from Non-Alignment and diplomacy to national security including Indo-US defense agreement of 1964.

3 Cold War was at its peak and limited cooperation between the two increased the importance of South Asian region.

4 Tashkent was India's test of balancing the superpowers.

5 Domestic political and economic situation were dismal.



3 1971 – 1991

- 1 This period saw greater Indian regional assertion with leaders like Indira Gandhi and Rajiv Gandhi, trying to consolidate its position in South Asia.
- 2 They focused on the South Asian region and intervened in internal affairs of domestic countries like East Pakistan (Bangladesh), Nepal and Sri Lanka.
- 3 The Sino-US rapprochement of 1971 changed the global landscape
- 4 Complex phase with US-China-Pakistan axis came into being at this time threatened India's prospects
- 5 1971 Indo- Soviet treaty and adoption of pro-Soviet position on international issues were India's response to this challenge.
- 6 With the fall of the Soviet Union, strong signs of shift in the alliance was visible by the end of the 1980s.



4

1991 - 2012

- 1 The unipolar world encouraged India to re-think radically on a variety of issues
- 2 India started becoming ambitious during this period and Focus shifted to safeguarding strategic autonomy
- 3 It wanted to harness its strengths and establish a place for itself at the Global level- nuclear test, participating in the UN missions and other multilateral institutions like IMF, ASEAN and BRICS. It wanted to spearhead its nuclear program and validate the 21st Century as the Asian Century.

4

Look East Policy and relations with countries like Israel summarized the changed Indian approach.

5

By 1998, India was an established nuclear power. It strengthened relations with US to buy nuclear technology and have a favorable trade.



5 CONTEMPORARY DEVELOPMENTS

- The contemporary developments of Foreign policy display India's positions aspiring to become a superpower of the 21st Century.
- World experiencing the after-effects of the global economic crisis and Sovereign debt crisis
- Multipolarity is the order of the day.
- World is converging into issue-based arrangements like Climate change
- India is more aware of its capabilities and pursues a more energetic diplomacy.



WE EXPRESS OUR
SINCERE THANKS
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

Presented by



Learning Space

For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

For Information:

info.learningspacedigital@gmail.com

Visit us at:

www.learningspacedigital.com

0866 244 44 72

98499 42299

94415 27588